Welcome to the

# Annual EOY Chemical Engineering Banquet

Hosted by ChemEConnect & AIChE



Co-Host/MC #1

# Joshua Olusoji

**Senior Chemical Engineering Student**

ChemEConnect Student Representative

President of AIChE

# Tonight's Agenda

| | |
|---|---|
| 5:30pm | ChemEConnect & Banquet Committee Acknowledgments by **Joshua Olusoji** |
| 5:45pm | Department Address feat. **Dr. Vikas Berry** |
| 5:50pm | AIChE End-of-Year Highlights presented by **Joshua Olusoji** |
| 6:00pm | Introduction to New AIChE Board by **Servando Casillas & Sophia Johnson** |
| 6:05pm | ChEGSA End-of-Year Highlights presented by **Zac Adesanya** |
| 6:10pm | Keynote Address featuring **Emily Seriruk** |
| 6:20pm | Special Remarks by **Professors Michael Caracotsios & Betul Bilgin** |
| 6:30pm | Graduate Student Symposium & Senior Design Awards presented by **Vianey Gonzalez** |
| 6:50pm | Chemical Engineering Department Superlatives presented by **Anna Cai** |
| 7:10pm | Closing Remarks & Networking Time |

# Who is ChemEConnect?



Joshua Olusoji



Zac Adesanya



Dr. Betul Bilgin



Dr. Korosh Torabi



Jan Sagun



Sarai Chavez

**A small group focused on bridging the gap between students, faculty, and staff!**






Thank you for all your hard work!

# Banquet Committee

A **special thanks** to our undergraduate banquet committee for helping put everything together!

Servando Casillas

Sophia Johnson

Trina Murell

Vianey Gonzalez

Basil Hashim

Anna Cai

Jazmin Aca

Joshua Olusoji



Department Address

# Dr. Vikas Berry

**Chemical Engineering Department Head**

CEO and Founder of Grapherry

Professor & Researcher at UIC

# Introducing the American Institute of Chemical Engineers **(AIChE)** Chapter at UIC

Student-led undergraduate organization in the ChE Department

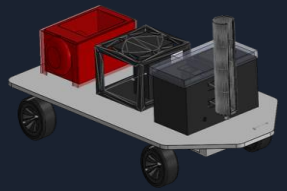
# Mission Statement

To foster an inclusive and supportive community for chemical engineering undergraduate students through professional development, social gatherings, and mentorship, creating opportunities to grow, gain experience, and build meaningful connections.

# AIChE EOY Highlights

## ChemECar

A student-led research and competition group that designs a car that runs and stops through chemical reactions!

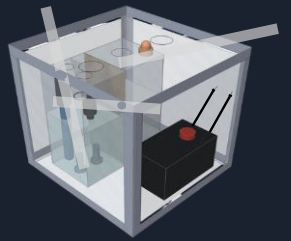




2026 Regionals in Purdue!

## ChemECube

A student-led research and competition group that designs a pilot-scale carbon capture device!






2025 Nationals in Boston!

# AIChE EOY Highlights

## Professional Events

- Q&A panels with industry professionals
- Plant visits and field trips
- Resume & LinkedIn workshops





Invenergy
Argonne NATIONAL LABORATORY
Constellation
abbvie
bp
DIAGEO
KraftHeinz
DOW
Ingredion
Tetra Pak
Pfanstiehl
P&G
Stepan



## Social Events







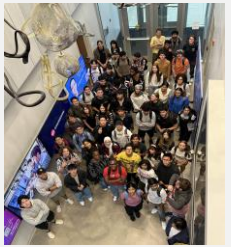












# AIChE EOY Highlights

## Volunteering & Fundraising

Raised over **$5,000** to help fund our competing teams & yearly events!









BANK OF AMERICA Chicago Marathon.

BANK OF AMERICA Shamrock Shuffle

projectc.u.r.e.





## Outreach

Volunteered for department yield events & EIEP programs and visited high schools to promote ChE at UIC!










## Mentorship

AIChE facilitated mentorship between upperclassmen and lowerclassmen through intro-CHE courses!





# Thank You 2025-2026 AIChE Board!

Joshua Olusoji — President

Basil Hashim — Vice President

Rishabh Patel — Treasurer

Patrick Flores — Parliamentarian

Anna Cai — Social Media Head

Khoa Nguyen — Social Media Chair

Miguel Piza — Activities Chair

Queen Adedire — Graphics Chair

Trina Murell — Secretary

Jazmin Aca— Publications Chair

Sophia Johnson — Outreach Chair

Omar Zaruk — Corporate Liaison

Iliana Perez — Programs Lead

Hussein Rezk — Social Media Chair

Qussay Suleiman — Technologies Chair

**And Many More!**

# New AIChE Board Address



## Servando Casillas

Junior Chemical Engineering Student
**Incoming President for AIChE**



## Sophia Johnson

Junior Chemical Engineering Student
**Incoming VP for AIChE**



ChEGSA EOY Highlights

# Zac Adesanya

**Graduate Chemical Engineering Student**

ChemEConnect Student Representative

President of ChEGSA

# Introducing the Chemical Engineering Graduate Student Association **(ChEGSA)** Chapter at UIC

Student-led graduate organization in the ChE Department

# Mission Statement

To advocate for the interests of graduate students by fostering a strong relationship with the University and the CHE Department administration, aiming to address the challenges affecting graduate students, and organizing academic and professional development activities to support their growth within CHE.

ChEGSA exists to enrich graduate studies at the Chemical Engineering department through academic, social, and professional development programs.

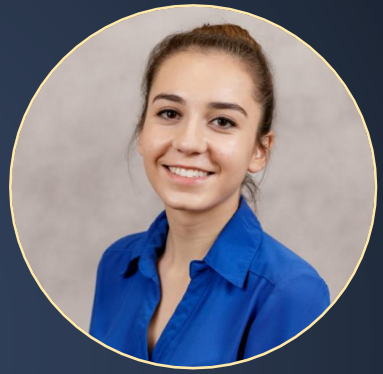
# 2025-2026 ChEGSA Board



Zac Adesanya



Najmin Hisa



Nadia Nikolova



Louie Edano



Pegah Sadeh



Karoll Cancino



Madina Sissenbay

# ChEGSA Activities Summary



Successful registration of ChEGSA with the Center for Student Involvement



Conducted detailed needs assessment of grad students and transmitted finding to the leadership at the lunch with friends



Enabled knowledge sharing through PhD Candidates Seminar Series



Initiated ChEGSA Celebrates to commemorate milestones and celebrate people.



Successfully organized the Graduate Research Symposium to showcase the innovations and results of our intellectual curiosities



Support the recruitment activities for new grad students

# PhD Candidate Series




**Louie Edano:**
"Stringiness and Extensional Rheology of Polymer Solutions"

**Bailin Feng:**
"Understanding Lipid Packing, Interactions, and Reactions at Interface by Using X-ray Scattering"

**Minoo Mosadegh:**
"Electrochemical Approaches for Assessing PFAS in Aqueous Systems"

**Taiwo Zacchaeus Adesanya:**
**"**Molecular Design of Lignin-based advanced materials"

**Atefeh Nadeali**
"Tailoring Magneli phase titanium suboxides for electrochemical nitrate reduction to ammonium."

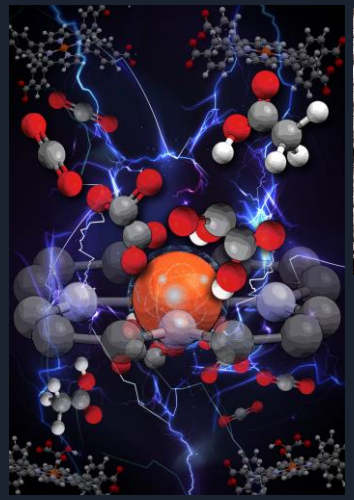
**Musawenkosi Ncube:**
"A computational study on electrochemical performance and cyclability of next generation lithium batteries"

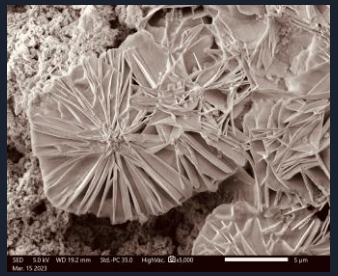
# Events


Chemical Engineering Graduate Student Association (ChEGSA)
LUNCH with FRIENDS
30th Oct 2025, 12:15-14:00
EIB 271, 929 W Taylor Str., 60607, Chicago IL
Sumptuous meals will be served.

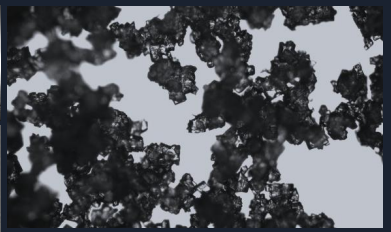

Chemical Engineering Graduate Student Association (ChEGSA) at UIC
GRADUATE RESEARCH SYMPOSIUM 2026
"Innovation from Molecules to Systems"
Dr. Gavin Towler
Ex-Chief Scientist, Honeywell LLC
Keynote Speaker & Panelist
Prof. Ying Liu
Dr. Satish Saxena & Asha Prof., UIC
Academic Panelist
Prof. Shafigh Mehraeen
Assistant Professor, UIC
Academic Panelist
Dr. Alison Lui
Senior Scientist, AbbVie Process Engineering
Industrial Panelist
Dr. Jelena Dinic
Senior Researcher, USG Corp
Industrial Panelist
Dr. M. Fettis-Koenders
R&D Bioprocess Engineer, Abbvie
Industrial Panelist
Student Competitions:
Image of Research | 3-Minute Thesis | Posters
RM 605, Student Center East (SCE), 750 S Halsted St, 60607, Chicago IL.
27th April, 2026 10:00 am - 3:00 pm
Proudly Sponsored by:
UIC ENGINEERING Chemical Engineering
eN-RAMPS

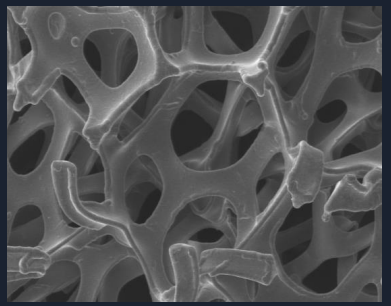
# Symposium: Image of Research





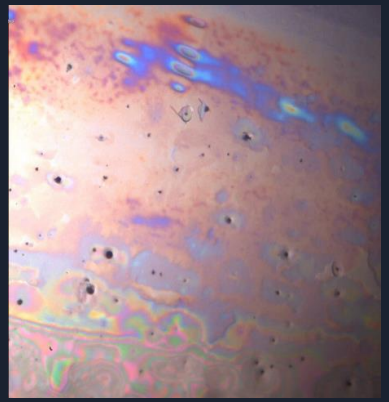


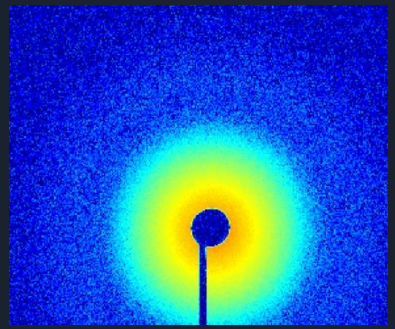


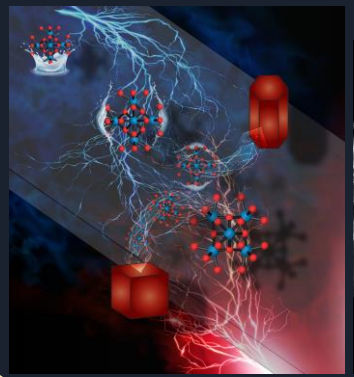


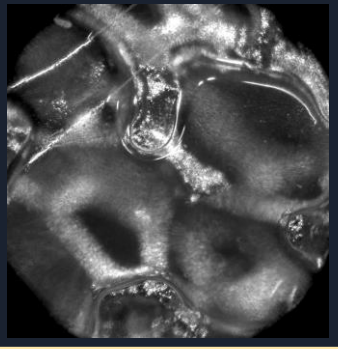










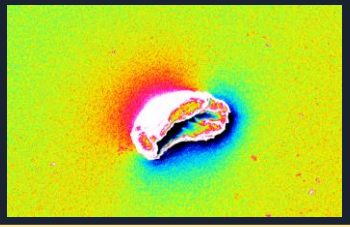


Image credits belong to Authors: Electrochemical CO2RR over a single metal catalyst - Prem Popodu, (2025); "Polymorphism in Electrodeposited Zirconium Metal—Organic Frameworks“ Prem Podupu (2024); "Crystal Flower" Saurabh Misal (2024); Micro Tortillas For A CO2 Valorization System - Rohan Sartape (2025); Spectroscopic Insight into Ni Foam Electrode During Electrochemical Ammonia Synthesis, Ishita Goyal (2025); A dance of drops and strings – Louie Edano, (2025); “Fragmentation in Polymeric Liquids” Yash Vidyasagar (2024); Bumps on LDPE – Zac Adesanya (2025), A Sky of Crystals - Karoll Cancino (2026), The Nickel Reef - Najmin Hisa, "Another metaphor by Jupiter!" (Orlando, Woolf): A washed-up Oat of this world milk soap -Kim Ngo, Synchrotron X-ray Fingerprint of Lipid Nanoparticle Structure - Bailin Feng

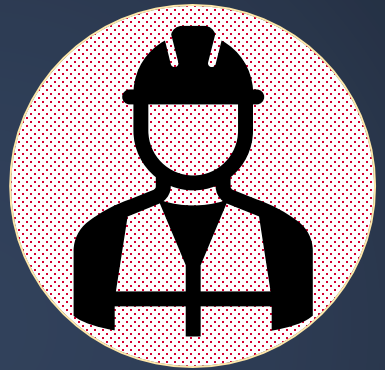
# 2026-2027 ChEGSA Board



Pegah Sadeh
President



Karoll Cancino
VP



Jazmine Samano
Treasurer



Zac Adesanya
Ex-Officio



Bailin Feng



Minoo Mosadegh



Matthew Gaughan



Bryce Askew



Co-Host/MC #2

# Vianey Gonzalez

**Sophomore Chemical Engineering Student**

Member of SHPE and AIChE

Incoming ChemEConnect Student Rep.



Keynote Speaker

# Emily Seriruk

**Chemical Engineering Alumni from UIC**

Product R&D Associate Scientist at KraftHeinz

Former President of AIChE



Special Remarks

# Dr. Michael Caracotsios

**Clinical Associate Professor at UIC**

Chemical Engr. Thermodynamics Textbook Author

Former Honeywell UOP Fellow



Special Remarks

# Dr. Betul Bilgin

**Clinical Professor at UIC**

Vice Chair for AIChE Education Division

AIChE at UIC Faculty Advisor

# Senior Design Awards

Winners of the Chemical Engineering Showcase held last week

# 4th Place Winner

Biomass-to-Jet: Using Gasification and Fischer-Tropsch Chemistry

Anna Cai, Qussay Suleiman, Jazmin Aca, Miguel Piza

Sponsored by: **Lance Baird LLC**

# 3rd Place Winner

From CO2 Emissions to Olefins

Hiba Naqvi, Angelica Ramirez, Javier Silva

Sponsored by: Honeywell UOP

# 2nd Place Winner

Fluoro Dynamics Specialty Materials

Kyle Hankosky, Khoa Nguyen, Lindsey Meisch, Kendall Johnson, Ahmed Alhassani

Sponsored by: NETenergy

# 1st Place Winner

## Clean Fuel Cleaner Skies: Ethanol to Jet Fuel

Omar Zaruk & Joshua Olusoji

Sponsored by:



# Thermodynamics Awards

Winners of the Thermodynamics Final Project

# 1st Place Winner

NaTherm

Caitlyn Pacholec, Omar Khudeira, Ruth Willrich Thieme

# Graduate Symposium Awards

Winners of today's Graduate Student Symposium Competitions

# PhD Candidate Series




**Louie Edano:**
"Stringiness and Extensional Rheology of Polymer Solutions"

**Bailin Feng:**
"Understanding Lipid Packing, Interactions, and Reactions at Interface by Using X-ray Scattering"

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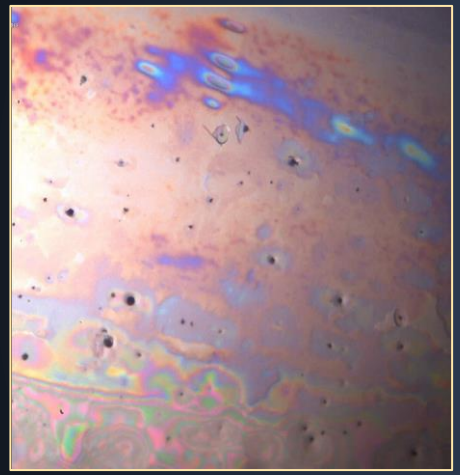
**Atefeh Nadeali**
"Tailoring Magneli phase titanium suboxides for electrochemical nitrate reduction to ammonium."

**Musawenkosi Ncube:**
"A computational study on electrochemical performance and cyclability of next generation lithium batteries"

# Poster Presentation Winners

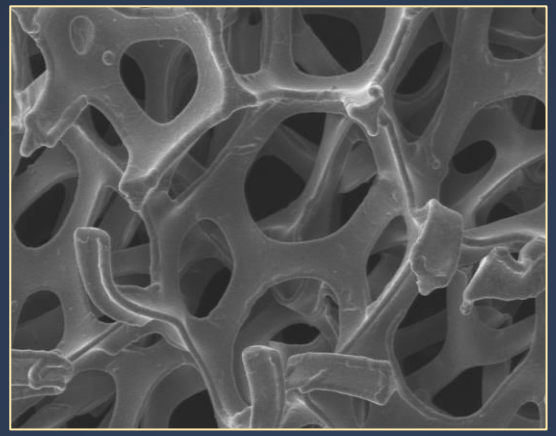
| | |
|---|---|
| **1st Place** | Atefeh Nadeali |
| **2nd Place** | Anuoluwaposimi Ijimakinwa |
| **3rd Place** | Kim Ngo |

# Image of Research Winners



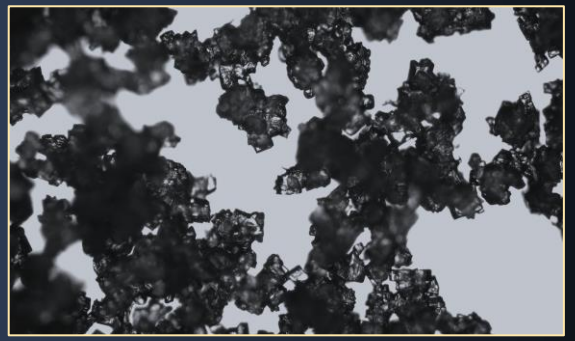
**3rd Place**

Kim Ngo



**1st Place**

Najmin Hisa



**2nd Place**

Karoll Cancino

# 3-Minute Thesis Winners

**1st Place** Mohaiminul Islam

**2nd Place** Aanchal Vashisht

**3rd Place** Atefeh Nadeali

# Student Achievements 2025-2026

| | |
|---|---|
| 1st Place in AIChE Graduate Student Poster Competition | Atefeh Nadeali |
| 2nd Place in AIChE Graduate Student Poster Competition | Minoo Mosadegh |
| ALD International Research Award | Pouyan Navabi |
| Missouri Valley Conference 2026 – Men's & Women's Swimming/Diving Scholar Athlete Team | Patton Shaar |

# Student Achievements 2025-2026

| | |
|---|---|
| Graduate Research & The Exceptional Teaching Promise Awards | Pegah Sadeh |
| Graduate College Award for Graduate Research & Excellence in Teaching and Mentoring Honorable Mention | Mehran Arzani |
| NSF 2026 Graduate Student Research & ChemMatCARS from Argonne Awards | Bailin Feng |
| 2025 Future of Rheology Excellent Speaker Award at Society of Rheology<br>2025 Adhesion Society Best Poster Award<br>2025 American Physical Society DSOFT Poster Prize<br>2025 BASF NORA Poster Prize | Nadia Nikolova |

# Student Achievements 2025-2026

| | |
|---|---|
| ChEGSA Research Symposium Image of Research Award | Louis Edano |
| AIChE Chicago Section McCormack Award | Joshua Olusoji |

# AIChE Chicago Poster Competition

| | |
|---|---|
| **1st Place** | Omar Zaruk & Joshua Olusoji |
| **2nd Place** | Anna Cai, Miguel Piza, Jazmin Aca, & Qussay Suleiman |
| **3rd Place** | Hiba Naqvi, Javier Silva, & Angelica Ramirez |



## Department Superlatives

# Anna Cai

**Senior Chemical Engineering Student**

Engineering Success Program TA

Social Media Head of AIChE

# Superlative Awards

Voted on by you!

# Most Likely to Engineer a Bright Future

A student who exhibits exceptional promise and potential in the field of chemical engineering

# Most Dedicated ChemE

A student who has dedicated the most effort towards homework, quizzes, and exams

# Friendliest ChemE

A student who consistently demonstrates warmth, kindness, and a welcoming attitude within the ChE community

# Most Navier-Stoked for Class

A student who is eager to learn and lifts the mood of others in class

# Best Reaction-Catalyst (Funniest)

Student with the best sense of humor

# Super Stylish ChemE

A student who always comes to class with great style

# Kindest Professor Award

Their compassion sparks courage and confidence in the students of chemical engineering

# Most Engaging Lecturer Award

A professor who ignites the love for learning each and every day

# Most Dedicated Professor Award

Awarded to the professor who puts in countless hours to see his students succeed

# Funniest Professor Award

A professor whose jokes permeate through the room.

# Staff Member of the Year

For solving all of the department's problems

# Raffle Winner

Drumroll.....